Lead with Love:
Why Passion Powers People and Progress

ISC2 Security Congress 2026 – Bright Ideas Roundtable Participant Handout

First Name & Last Initial: _____

> *"Leadership is not about being in charge. It's about taking care of those in your charge."* — Simon Sinek

---

SECTION 1 — LET'S CONNECT FIRST

Turn to the people at your table, share your first name and location, and choose *one* of the prompts below to share:

1. Describe a leader who made you feel truly seen and valued. What did they do specifically?
2. Share a moment when trust was either built or broken in a team you were part of. What made the difference?
3. If your team described you as a leader in three words, what words would you *hope* they used and what words do you *fear* they might use?

My Notes / Key Takeaways from the Icebreaker

NOTE: Please keep conversations confidential.

SECTION 2 — THE TRUST EQUATION: HOW TRUST IS BUILT

The *Trust Equation*, developed by Maister, Green & Galford in *The Trusted Advisor*, offers a practical framework for understanding how trust is created and destroyed. It shows that trust is not simply about competence — it is equally shaped by how we make others feel and whether we are genuinely focused on their needs.

Trust = (Credibility + Reliability + Intimacy) ÷ Self-Orientation

How to read this: Higher scores in *Credibility*, *Reliability*, and *Intimacy* increase trust. A higher Self-Orientation score *divides* — and therefore reduces — the total trust others place in you.

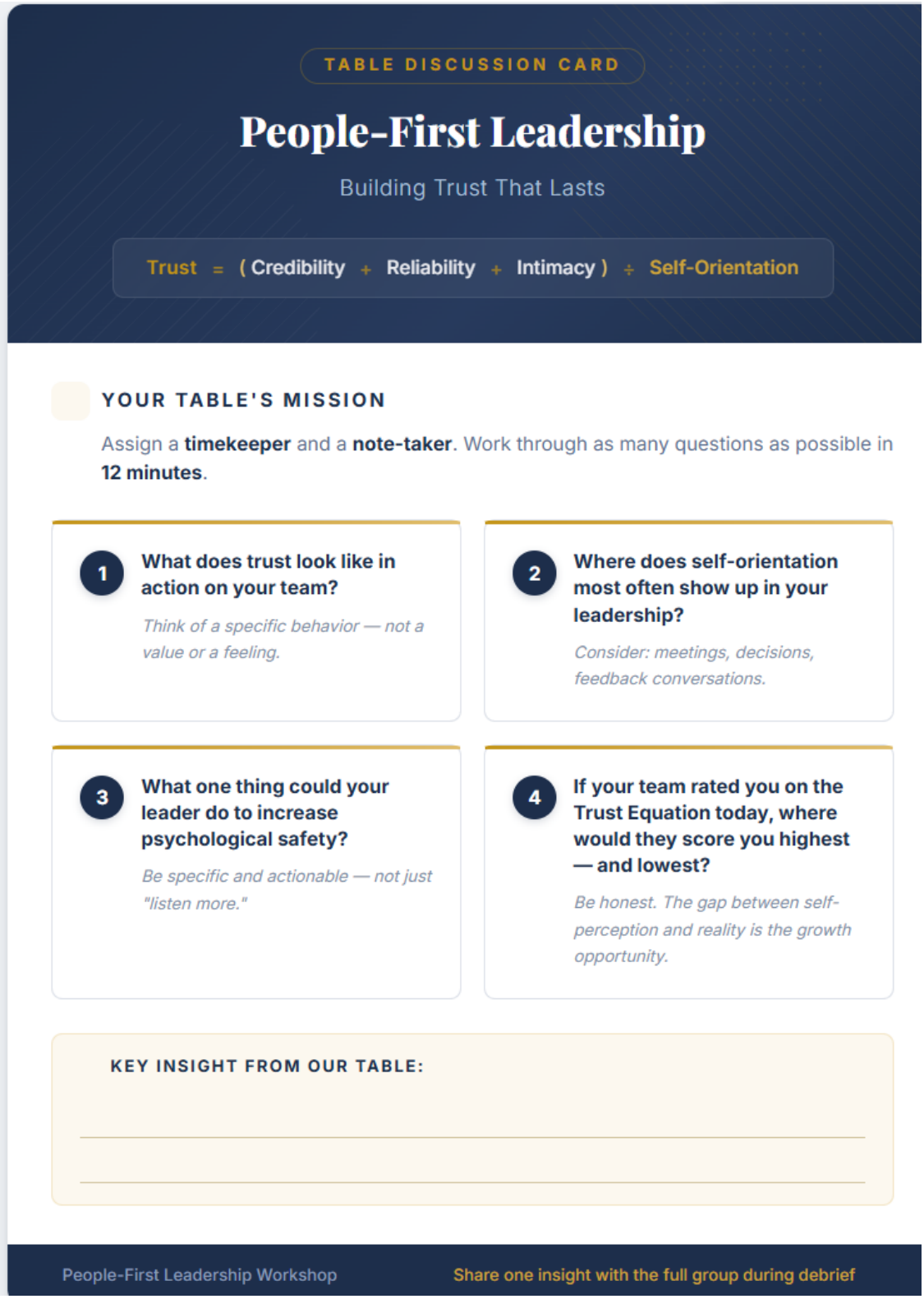
Component	Definition	Reflection Question	Self-Rating 1 = Needs Work 5 = Strength
Credibility	People believe what I say and trust my expertise.	*When did you last update your knowledge or skills to stay credible in your role?*	**1 2 3 4 5**
Reliability	I consistently follow through on commitments.	*What systems or habits help you keep your promises — and where do you sometimes fall short?*	**1 2 3 4 5**
Intimacy	People feel emotionally safe sharing concerns with me.	*How do you create psychological safety for your team to be honest with you?*	**1 2 3 4 5**
Self-Orientation	I am focused on others' needs, *not* just my own agenda.	*Think of a recent decision — how much of it was driven by your own comfort versus your team's needs?*	**1 2 3 4 5** ▲ Lower is better

⚠ Your Trust Score Insight:

High self-orientation is the single biggest trust-killer in leadership. Even if your Credibility, Reliability, and Intimacy scores are strong, a self-serving orientation can override all of them — because people will sense when your decisions are ultimately about you. The most trusted leaders make it unmistakably clear that their team's success comes first.

One thing I can do THIS WEEK to strengthen my trust score:

SECTION 3 — ACHIEVING PEOPLE-FIRST LEADERSHIP



NOTE: Please keep conversations confidential.

SECTION 4 — MY PEOPLE-FIRST LEADERSHIP PLEDGE

Leadership intentions matter — but commitments in writing are where change begins.

◆ A Personal Commitment to People-Centered Leadership ◆

I, _____ , commit to leading with people at the center of every decision I make.

I pledge to listen before I speak, to follow through on what I promise, and to create space where my team can do their best work.

Specifically, I will:

- _____
- _____
- _____

I recognize that trust is earned through consistent daily actions, not titles or authority.

Signed: _____ Date: _____

Additional actions I am taking in the next week:

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

KEEP THE MOMENTUM GOING

Key Takeaways:

1. Soft Skills Are Strategic Skills — Not "Nice-to-Haves."

You will recognize that emotional intelligence, active listening, adaptability, and conflict resolution are *core leadership competencies* that directly influence team resilience, collaboration, and performance in technical environments.

2. Trust Is Built Through Phileo Love — Human Care in Action.

You will understand that leadership grounded in empathy, presence, and authentic connection creates psychological safety, strengthens loyalty, and transforms technical teams into high-trust, high-impact communities.

3. Self-Awareness Is the Foundation of Effective Leadership.

Using a soft-skills maturity model and the Trust Equation, you will evaluate their interpersonal habits, identify strengths and gaps, and gain clarity on how your personal passions shape their leadership identity.

4. People-First Leadership Accelerates Technical Outcomes.

Leaders will see how human-centered behaviors, such as mentoring, coaching, supportive communication, and consistent reliability, reduce friction, improve decision-making, and elevate team performance during high-pressure technical work.

5. Leadership Is a Daily Practice, Not a Position.

You will leave with actionable behaviors and a co-created "People-First Leadership Pledge," empowering them to model compassion, clarity, and trust-building habits that inspire others and sustain long-term career fulfillment.

Next Steps:

- _____
- _____
- _____

Resources:

Your growth as a people-first leader doesn't end when the workshop does. The following resources will deepen your practice:

Type	Resource	Why It Matters
📚 Recommended Book	*The Trusted Advisor* Maister, Green & Galford	The foundational framework behind today's Trust Equation — essential reading for any leader building lasting relationships.
📚 Recommended Book	*Leaders Eat Last* Simon Sinek	Explores why the best leaders prioritize their people's well-being and how that creates extraordinary organizations.
📚 Recommended Book	*Dare to Lead* Brené Brown	A research-based guide to courageous leadership, vulnerability, and building cultures of psychological safety.
📚 Recommended Website	*The Cyber Canon,* *https://cybercanon.org/*	A curated list of top cybersecurity books
✏️ Ongoing Practice	Journal weekly on one **trust-building moment** and one **missed opportunity**. Reflection accelerates growth.	

Additional Notes

Thank you for investing in yourself and your team today.